

KITE SPOTS — BELIZE TO COSTA RICA

ranked for Oct 27 — Nov 15, 2026 and for the year · five countries · odds are estimates from published season data, not forecasts · 2026-09-05

RANKED FOR THE WINDOW — OCT 27 - NOV 15			RANKED FOR THE YEAR		
#	SPOT	WHY	#	SPOT	WHY
1	Bahía Salinas — Playa Copal / Papaturro, Costa Rica	season opens the week you arrive; November averages 17 kn, ~90% of days ride Nov–May; schools rent full kits; you are there Nov 2–15	1	Bahía Salinas, Costa Rica	~90% of days Nov–May, 22–23 kn Dec–Feb, Papagayo side-onshore into a bay; the region’s benchmark
2	Lake Atitlán, Guatemala	xocomil thermal 8–17 kn from noon; one source calls Oct–Dec the best season; boat starts with the school; collides with the work block and sits 3 h off the route	2	Camp Bay / Paya Bay, Roatán, Honduras	E trades 15–30 kn daily Feb–Aug, 25+ days a month in summer, reef waves outside and shelter inside; school with rescue boat Dec–Sep
3	Ometepe — Playa Santo Domingo, Nicaragua	windy Nov–Jul, 15–25 kn; two schools; sandy shallow launch; costs a ferry day but the ferry port is on the way to the Costa Rica border	3	Little Corn Island, Nicaragua	Nov–Jul, 15–25 kn Nov–Feb, warm Caribbean water, small scene
4	Lake Nicaragua at Granada, Nicaragua	same trades, 15–23 kn gusty when on; the season’s first days fall on Nov 1–2; no Granada-based rental verified	4	Ometepe, Nicaragua	Nov–Jul, 15–25 kn, fresh flat shallow water under two volcanoes, two schools
5	Little Corn Island, Nicaragua	Nov–Feb 15–25 kn and a school on the east beach, but it is a Managua flight plus a panga – two days you do not have	5	Caye Caulker, Belize	Feb–Jul 12–20 kn, best Feb and Jun; shallow flat water right off the island
6	Caye Caulker, Belize	flat reef lagoon and a school, but the caye’s own season is Feb–Jul; late October is light	6	Lake Arenal, Costa Rica	Dec–May 20–30 kn, high-wind lake, gusts off the hills
7	Lake Arenal, Costa Rica	Dec–May 20–30 kn side-on, gusty; November is the shoulder and the main operator opens for the dry season – confirm	7	Lake Atitlán, Guatemala	thermal 8–17 kn afternoons in the dry season; the most beautiful launch on the list, not the windiest
			8	Ambergris Caye, Belize	Jan–Apr; more scene than wind
			9	Utila, Honduras	Dec–Apr trades at Chepes Beach; a diving island that also kites
			10	Placencia / Hopkins, Belize	mainland; Apr–May best

METHOD

Five criteria, in order: (1) wind probability inside the window, from each spot’s published season and monthly averages; (2) water and launch — flat, shallow, onshore scores above gusty, boat-start or offshore; (3) a school or rental on site, because the plan is harness-and-bar only; (4) access from the route in hours and transfers; (5) fit with the 12:00–20:00 work block, so afternoon-only thermals lose points. Odds bands: high ≥70%, medium 40–70%, low 15–40%, none <15%. Late October is the tail of the wet season everywhere; the Papagayo and Caribbean trades switch on through November.

EVERY SPOT, ONE ROW EACH Oct 27 – Nov 15 odds are for your dates; season data from the sources listed

SPOT	WIND	WATER · LAUNCH	WINDOW ODDS	SCHOOL · RENTAL	ACCESS FROM THE ROUTE	VERDICT
BAHÍA SALINAS Costa Rica · Playa Copal · Papaturro · Coyotera, Guanacaste	Papagayo trades, side-onshore into the bay. Season early Nov → end May, plus July; ~90% of days. Monthly averages: Nov 17 · Dec 22 · Jan 23 · Feb 23 · Mar 19 · Apr 17 · May 16 kn. Blows through the day, strongest midday.	Bay with chop, sandy launches; Copal is the school beach, Papaturro flatter; strong gusts on the big days.	HIGH · ~85% you are here Nov 2–15; November is a 12 m month, rising weekly	Several schools at Copal and Papaturro rent full kits (~\$50–80 a session, ~\$250–350 a week; confirm) and teach.	15–20 km from the Peñas Blancas border; 1 h from Liberia; 5 h from San José. From Granada it is closer by land than by air.	The trip’s kite. Base here first, not last.
LAKE ATITLÁN Guatemala · Panajachel · Santa Catarina Palopó · Isla de los Gatos	The xocomil: a thermal that builds noon–16:00, 8–17 kn, generally south; dry season Nov–Apr, and one operator rates Oct–Dec best. Can raise 1–2 m chop.	Deep caldera lake, boat starts with the school, cold-ish fresh water, wind lines with holes.	MEDIUM · ~55% in season on your dates, but it blows 12–16 — inside the work block	Kite School Guatemala and iKiteGt run lessons on Atitlán (and Amatitlán); rentals through them, boat included.	3 h shuttle from Antigua. Not on the Plan C route; the Plan B alternate day.	A Plan B day, not a Plan C stop. Beautiful, light, afternoon-only.
OMETEPE Nicaragua · Playa Santo Domingo, Lake Nicaragua	NE trades across the lake, windy Nov → end Jul, 15–25 kn; best Dec–Mar and mid-Jun–Jul. Steady rather than gusty on the beach.	Sandy beach, shallow fresh water, onshore, volcano backdrop. The friendliest launch in Nicaragua.	MEDIUM · ~50% the season opens in November; Nov 1 is week one	Two schools: Ometepe Kite Center and Kitesurf Ometepe (private lessons, rental).	Granada → San Jorge 1 h, ferry 1 h, then 40 min to Santo Domingo. San Jorge is on the road to the Costa Rica border.	Nicaragua’s reliable kite. Costs a ferry day; pays it back on the way to the border.
LAKE NICARAGUA AT GRANADA Nicaragua · west shore south of the city, near the isletas	Same NE trades, 15–23 kn average when on, gusty, max ~34 kn; season Nov–Apr, best Dec–Mar. Year-round direction NE.	Brown fresh water, chop, onshore on the west shore; launches are informal.	MEDIUM · ~40% first Papagayo days of the season; a coin flip each morning	kitesurfnicaragua.org runs lake lessons from Granada or Ometepe in the wet season; no Granada-based rental verified — confirm before counting on it.	Walkable from town. Zero transit cost, which is why it is in Plan C.	Worth a morning if a rental exists; otherwise a run on the malecón.
LITTLE CORN ISLAND Nicaragua · east beach	Windy season Nov → end Jul; Nov–Feb 15–25 kn (N turning NE in Jan); Mar–May 12–20; Jun–Sep 10–18; a lull in May.	Warm Caribbean water, reef, the east beach launch by the school.	MEDIUM · ~60% wind is likely; the island is two days away	kitesurfnicaragua.org and Wingsurf Corn Islands, kite and wing, on the east beach.	Managua → Big Corn by La Costeña ~1.5 h, then a 30-min panga. Not reachable inside this window.	A separate trip. The best Caribbean kite in Nicaragua.
CAYE CAULKER Belize · the Split and the lee shore	Steady 12–20 kn Feb–Jul, best Feb and Jun; Dec–Jun averages 15–18 kn, 20+ in the mornings; summer 10–16. The country-wide dry season is Nov–Apr, but the caye’s own reliable window starts in February.	Shallow, flat, turquoise water straight off the island inside the barrier reef — the best water on this list.	LOW · ~25% late October is the wet-season tail; light unless a front pushes through	A kite school on the island (Kitexplorer) and Velenito rentals; low-season hours to confirm.	You are here Oct 30–31 anyway.	A swim with a kite bag nearby. If it blows, the school is a two-minute walk.
LAKE ARENAL Costa Rica · Tilawa · Tronadora, north shore	Dry-season high-wind lake: Dec → May, 20–30 kn side-onshore, gusty off the hills.	Fresh water, chop, some swell on the big days; mountain gusts.	LOW · ~30% November is the shoulder; the main operator opens for the dry season — confirm the date	Tico Wind runs the windsurf/kite center in season.	3 h from Liberia, 3.5 h from San José; on the way from Guanacaste to the volcano.	December’s spot. Pass through Nov 8–12 only if Salinas is already delivering.
CAMP BAY / PAYA BAY Honduras · east end of Roatán	E trades 15–30 kn daily Feb → end Aug; Apr–May strongest (30+ days), Jun–Aug the most consistent (25+ days, 18–25 kn). Wind switches ESE→ENE around noon and builds after 15:00.	Roatán’s largest natural beach: sheltered water inside, waves on the reef; Pigeon Cay for advanced riders.	NONE · ~15% off-season and the school is closed Oct–Nov	Kitesurf Roatán: beach assistants and a rescue boat, open December → September.	A flight from San Pedro Sula; not on the route.	Honduras’ best kite, in a month it does not blow. Not this trip.
UTILA Honduras · Chepes Beach · Little Bight · Rocky Point	E trades Dec → Apr; shallow sheltered turquoise water.	Sheltered lagoon, sandy; small island, small scene.	LOW · ~15% off-season	Kitesurf & Flyboard Utila; a Facebook-scale operation — confirm it is active.	Ferry from La Ceiba or flight from SAP; not on the route.	Diving island that also kites. Not this trip.

SPOT	WIND	WATER · LAUNCH	WINDOW ODDS	SCHOOL · RENTAL	ACCESS FROM THE ROUTE	VERDICT
AMBERGRIS CAYE — SAN PEDRO Belize · inside the reef, north of town	Season Jan → Apr with the dry-season trades.	Reef-protected flat water; busier than Caye Caulker.	LOW · ~20% off-season	Shops and instructors in San Pedro.	Water taxi from Belize City; Caye Caulker is the better base for the same water.	Skip; Caye Caulker has the same lagoon with less town.
PLACENCIA · HOPKINS Belize · mainland peninsula and Garifuna coast	Apr–May the best months for wind sports on this coast; dry-season trades Nov–Apr at 15–25 kn on paper.	Long sandy peninsula, open water, less reef shelter than the cayes.	LOW · ~15% off-season, and off the route	Placencia has the mainland's kite operators; seasonal.	A day's bus from Belize City or the Placencia water taxi.	Not this trip.
LAKE AMATITLÁN Guatemala · 25 km south of Guatemala City	Light, stable thermal; used by the Guatemala school for teaching.	Warm crater lake; heavily polluted — the reason it is a lesson venue, not a destination.	LOW · ~25% close to the airport, light wind, dirty water	Kite School Guatemala teaches here as well as on Atitlán.	45 min from the airport.	Only if a rested afternoon appears between the flight and Antigua. Unlikely.
POPOYO · GUASACATE Nicaragua · Pacific coast, Tola	The Papagayo blows offshore here, which is what makes the surf glassy; kiting exists at Guasacate and Astillero on side-shore days in season.	Surf beaches; offshore wind means a kite goes to sea.	NONE · ~10% a surf spot with a kite footnote	Surf camps; no dedicated kite school verified.	2 h from Granada.	Bring the surfboard, not the kite.

THE CALL, BY COUNTRY

COSTA RICA — The only high-odds wind in the window. Bahía Salinas opens in early November at ~17 kn averages and climbs to 22-23 by December; Lake Arenal follows from December. You land in the country on Nov 2 and stay to Nov 15 — that is the trip’s kite block, and the reason to arrive at Salinas rather than San José.

NICARAGUA — Season opens the week you are there. Ometepe’s Santo Domingo is the reliable, schooled, sandy option; Granada’s lakeshore is the zero-transit option with no verified rental. Little Corn is the best Caribbean wind in the country and two days out of reach.

GUATEMALA — One real spot, Lake Atitlán, thermal and afternoon-only, in season on your dates. It costs three hours off the route and the middle of the work block. A Plan B day.

BELIZE — The best flat water on the list and the wrong month. Caye Caulker’s own window is February to July. Swim, snorkel, run the island; kite if a front arrives.

HONDURAS — Camp Bay on Roatán is the region’s second-best spot for the year and blows February to August; the school is closed in October and November. Copán, where the route actually goes, has no wind at all.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR THE ROUTE

- 1. Re-derive the Nov 2 leg: Bahía Salinas is 15-20 km from the Peñas Blancas border. Granada → Rivas → border → La Cruz is 3-4 h by road with the crossing; the MGA → SJO flight (\$120-250) lands you five hours from the wind. Go by land, arrive at Playa Copal by early afternoon Nov 2, and let San José wait. Border 06:00-22:00 (Sundays to 20:00); Nov 2 is a Monday.
- 2. If Nicaragua kiting matters, swap the second Granada night for Ometepe: Granada Oct 31 → San Jorge ferry Nov 1 → Santo Domingo (two schools, sandy launch) → back to San Jorge Nov 2, which is already on the road to the border. Odds rise from ~40% to ~50% and the launch is far safer; the cost is one ferry and a 40-min road, ~\$25-40.
- 3. Belize stays a swim. Keep the Caye Caulker morning as snorkel and run; check the school on arrival and ride only if the trades show.
- 4. Guatemala: Atitlán only in Plan B, and only by moving that day’s work block to 16:00-24:00 or accepting a dead block. Not worth it against a Copán morning unless the forecast the week before shows 15+ kn.
- 5. Gear: harness, bar, and a leash. Rent at Copal or Papaturro for the fortnight (a weekly rate beats sessions after day four); rent on Ometepe by the hour. Leave the quiver; four flights, three of them Cessnas.
- 6. Pre-register the forecast: 70% that Salinas delivers a rideable day within the first three days (Nov 2-4); 40% that Granada does on Nov 1; 20% that Caye Caulker does on Oct 31. Score them on arrival.

VERIFY BEFORE YOU RELY ON IT

- A Granada-based kite rental in early November — none verified; the lake school operates from Granada or Ometepe on request.
- Tico Wind (Lake Arenal) opening date for the 2026-27 season.
- Bahía Salinas school rental prices and weekly rates; whether Papaturro or Copal has the lighter-wind beginner-friendly launch on 12 m days.
- The Rivas → La Cruz / Bahía Salinas transfer on Nov 2: Tica Bus to Liberia, a colectivo from the border, or a private car (~\$40-60).
- Caye Caulker school hours in late October (low season).
- Ometepe ferry times from San Jorge on Nov 1 and back on Nov 2 (roughly hourly by day; the last boats are mid-afternoon).

SOURCES

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